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Conversation: **Conda Essentials** | Exported: May 06, 2026 16:27 UTC

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Conda Fundamentals

Conda is a package management system that allows users to create isolated environments for their projects. It provides an easy way to manage packages and their dependencies. Conda can be used to install, update, and manage packages, as well as create and manage environments. The basic functionality of Conda can be verified and updated using specific commands.

Conda Basics Technical Core: Verify conda installation and check version number using `conda info`. Key Procedures: Update conda to the current version with `conda update conda`, and install a package using `conda install PACKAGENAME`. Critical Insights: The `conda info` command provides essential information about the Conda installation. Environment Management

Conda allows users to create isolated environments for their projects, making it easy to manage dependencies and packages. Environments can be created, cloned, and managed using specific commands.

Creating Environments Technical Core: Create a new environment using `conda create --name py35 python=3.5`. Key Procedures: Activate the environment with `activate py35` (Windows) or `source activate py35` (Linux, macOS), and list all environments using `conda env list`. Critical Insights: Environment names must be unique and can be specified using the `--name` option. Managing Environments Technical Core: Clone an environment using `conda create --clone py35 --name py35-2`. Key Procedures: List packages and versions in an environment with `conda list`, and save the environment to a text file using `conda list --explicit > bio-env.txt`. Critical Insights: Cloning an environment creates a new environment with the same packages and versions. Package Management

Conda provides an easy way to install, update, and manage packages within environments.

Installing and Updating Packages Technical Core: Install a package in the active environment using `conda install PACKAGENAME`. Key Procedures: Install a package in a specific environment with `conda install --name bio-env toolz`, and update a package using `conda update PACKAGENAME`. Critical Insights: Packages can be installed in specific environments using the `--name` option. Package Versioning Technical Core: Specify a package version using `numpy=1.11`, `numpy==1.11`, or `numpy>=1.11`. Key Procedures: Use quotation marks for specifications with spaces or special characters, such as `"numpy>=1.8,<2"`. Critical Insights: Version specifications can include equality, inequality, and range operators. Advanced Environment Management

Conda provides additional functionality for managing environments, including removal, deactivation, and creation from text files.

Environment Management Technical Core: Remove an environment using `conda env remove --name bio-env`. Key Procedures: Deactivate the current environment with `deactivate` (Windows) or `source deactivate` (Linux, macOS), and create an environment from a text file using `conda env`

create --file bio-env.txt. Critical Insights: Environment removal is permanent and cannot be undone. Additional Functionality

Conda provides additional commands for searching packages, getting help, and running packages.

Miscellaneous Technical Core: Search for a package using `conda search PACKAGENAME`. Key Procedures: Get help for a command with `conda install --help`, and run a package after installation using `jupyter-notebook`. Critical Insights: The `conda search` command provides a list of available packages and their versions.